

## Kassandra Hernández

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| CONTACT INFORMATION                           | 650 Evans Hall<br>Department of Economics, UC Berkeley                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <a href="mailto:kassandra.hernandez@berkeley.edu">kassandra.hernandez@berkeley.edu</a><br><a href="#">Personal Website</a> |
| RESEARCH INTERESTS                            | Labor Economics, Education, Immigration, Inequality, Public Policy                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                            |
| EDUCATION                                     | <b>University of California, Berkeley</b><br>Ph.D. in Economics                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2021-Present                                                                                                               |
|                                               | <b>UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs</b><br>Master of Public Policy (MPP)                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2020                                                                                                                       |
|                                               | <b>Michigan State University</b><br>AEA Summer Training Program (Advanced Track)                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2020                                                                                                                       |
|                                               | <b>University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)</b><br>B.A. in Philosophy (Labor Studies minor)<br>Summa Cum Laude · College Honors · Departmental Honors                                                                                                                                  | 2017                                                                                                                       |
| ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (GRADUATE LEVEL) | <b>Graduate Research Fellow</b> , UC Berkeley Labor Center<br><i>Advisor: Dr. Enrique Lopezlira</i>                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2023-2026                                                                                                                  |
|                                               | <b>Graduate Research Fellow</b> , California Policy Lab (UCB)<br><i>Advisor: Dr. Jesse Rothstein</i>                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2022-2023                                                                                                                  |
|                                               | <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b> , UCLA<br><i>Advisor: Dr. R. Jisung Park</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2019                                                                                                                       |
| POLICY RESEARCH EXPERIENCE                    | <b>Research Analyst</b> , UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute<br><i>Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas</i>                                                                                                                                                                        | 2021                                                                                                                       |
|                                               | <b>Research Fellow</b> , UCLA LPPI<br><i>Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2020                                                                                                                       |
| TEACHING EXPERIENCE                           | <b>Instructor</b> , PPIA Summer Institute<br>– <i>Quantitative Methods</i> (undergraduate)                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2024                                                                                                                       |
|                                               | <b>Teaching Associate</b> , UCLA<br>– <i>Using Data Science to Learn about Society</i> (undergraduate)<br>– <i>Information, Evidence, and Persuasion</i> (undergraduate)<br>– <i>Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis II</i> (graduate)<br>– <i>MPP Summer Math Camp</i> (graduate, x2) | 2019-2020                                                                                                                  |
|                                               | <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , UCLA<br>– <i>Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis I</i> (graduate)<br>– <i>Research &amp; Internships in Food Studies</i> (undergraduate, x2)                                                                                                               | 2019                                                                                                                       |

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| ACADEMIC WORK<br>IN PROGRESS            | “When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocu-<br>mented Students Success,” with Teresita Cruz Vital                            |           |
|                                         | “Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California’s Private Attorneys General Act on<br>Business Behavior Across the State,” with Enrique Lopezlira               |           |
|                                         | “Who Leads and Who Pays? Worker-led Enforcement and Differential Effects across<br>Industries”                                                                  |           |
|                                         | “Goodbye EFC, Hello SAI: How FAFSA Simplification Impacts Students’ Educational<br>and Credit Outcomes,” with Hannah Case, Teresita Cruz Vital, and Steve Ramos |           |
|                                         | “Skills without the Bills? Apprenticeships, Career Technical Education, and Consumer<br>Credit Outcomes” with Gaby Lohner and Steve Ramos                       |           |
| FELLOWSHIPS<br>AND AWARDS<br>(GRADUATE) | <i>UC Office of the President,</i>                                                                                                                              | 2026      |
|                                         | UC President’s Pre-Professoriate Fellowship (UC PPPF)                                                                                                           |           |
|                                         | <i>UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor &amp; Employment,</i>                                                                                            | 2026      |
|                                         | Dissertation Fellowship                                                                                                                                         |           |
|                                         | <i>Wheelhouse at UC Davis,</i>                                                                                                                                  | 2026      |
|                                         | Summer Scholars Fellowship                                                                                                                                      |           |
|                                         | <i>California Policy Lab,</i>                                                                                                                                   | 2024      |
|                                         | Graduate Fellowship                                                                                                                                             |           |
|                                         | <i>UC Berkeley,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2024      |
|                                         | Outstanding Graduate Organization Leadership Award                                                                                                              |           |
|                                         | <i>The Ford Foundation,</i>                                                                                                                                     | 2023      |
|                                         | Honorable Mention                                                                                                                                               |           |
|                                         | <i>UC Berkeley,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2021-2023 |
|                                         | Cota Robles Fellowship                                                                                                                                          |           |
|                                         | <i>UC Berkeley Department of Economics,</i>                                                                                                                     | 2021-2023 |
|                                         | Departmental Award                                                                                                                                              |           |
|                                         | <i>AEA Summer Training Program,</i>                                                                                                                             | 2020      |
|                                         | Best Paper in Advanced Track                                                                                                                                    |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs,</i>                                                                                                                    | 2020      |
|                                         | MPP Commencement Speaker                                                                                                                                        |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2020      |
|                                         | Outstanding Academic Achievement                                                                                                                                |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2020      |
|                                         | Teaching Assistant Award                                                                                                                                        |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2020      |
|                                         | Leadership & Service Award                                                                                                                                      |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2019      |
|                                         | Graduate Fellowship                                                                                                                                             |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA Luskin,</i>                                                                                                                                             | 2019      |
|                                         | Calvin and Marilyn Gross Fellowship                                                                                                                             |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA,</i>                                                                                                                                                    | 2019      |
|                                         | UC Regents Graduate Award                                                                                                                                       |           |
|                                         | <i>UCLA,</i>                                                                                                                                                    | 2018      |
|                                         | Graduate Opportunity Fellowship                                                                                                                                 |           |

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| RESEARCH<br>GRANTS        | <i>W.E. Upjohn Institute &amp; Russel Sage Foundation (RSF),</i>                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2026 |
|                           | – Dissertation Research Grant (\$15,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |      |
|                           | <i>Washington Center for Equitable Growth,</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2024 |
|                           | – Early Career Grant (\$15,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |      |
|                           | <i>Family Policy to Reduce Racial Inequities in Health,</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2024 |
|                           | – Graduate Student Research Award (\$30,000)<br><i>with Teresita Cruz Vital &amp; Alessandro Marchetti-Bowick</i>                                                                                                                                             |      |
|                           | <i>UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor &amp; Employment,</i>                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2024 |
|                           | – Graduate Student Research Award (\$6,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |      |
|                           | <i>California Policy Lab,</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2023 |
|                           | – Seed Grant (\$7,443)<br><i>with Teresita Cruz Vital</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |      |
|                           | <i>UC Berkeley Economics,</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2021 |
|                           | – Award for Gender-Related Research (\$9,000)<br><i>with Teresita Cruz Vital</i>                                                                                                                                                                              |      |
| SELECTED<br>PRESENTATIONS | “When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocumented Students Success”                                                                                                                                                         |      |
|                           | – <b>2024-2025 AY</b> : Freedom & Justice Summer Conference                                                                                                                                                                                                   |      |
|                           | – <b>2025-2026 AY</b> : UC Berkeley Department of Economics Public Finance Seminar, Labor Lunch Series, Labor Mini Symposium; Western Economic Association International (WAEI) Annual Meeting                                                                |      |
|                           | – <b>2026-2027 AY</b> (Planned): UC President’s Postdoctoral Fellowship Program Fall Meeting; Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting                                                                                                              |      |
|                           | “Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California’s Private Attorneys General Act on Business Behavior Across the State”                                                                                                                                        |      |
|                           | – <b>2024-2025 AY</b> : American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; Freedom & Justice Summer Conference; Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting; Labor & Employment Relations Association (LERA)                    |      |
| POLICY<br>PUBLICATIONS    | – <b>2025-2026 AY</b> : Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Research Workshop                                                                                                                                                                      |      |
|                           | – <b>2026-2027 AY</b> (Planned): UC Berkeley IRLE Scholars Meeting; UC Berkeley Department of Economics Labor Lunch Series                                                                                                                                    |      |
|                           | “Demographic and Job Characteristics of Baltimore’s Security Guard Workforce” (2025). UC Berkeley Labor Center. –with Enrique Lopezlira & Nari Rhee                                                                                                           |      |
|                           | – Complementary work also considers the security guard workforce in: Seattle and Washington; California; United States                                                                                                                                        |      |
|                           | “Highlighting the Diversity of California’s Asian American and Pacific Islander Workforce” (2025). UC Berkeley Labor Center.                                                                                                                                  |      |
|                           | “Who are California’s American Indian and Alaska Native Low-wage Workers?” (2024). UC Berkeley Labor Center.                                                                                                                                                  |      |
|                           | <i>Latinas Exiting the Workforce: How the Pandemic Revealed Historic Disadvantages and Heightened Economic Hardship</i> (2021). UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute (LPPI). –with Diana Garcia, Paula Nazario, Michael Rios, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas |      |
|                           | <i>A Path to Prosperity: The Macroeconomic Benefits of Four Immigrant Regulariza-</i>                                                                                                                                                                         |      |

*tion Scenarios* (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Raúl Hinojosa-Ojeda, Sherman Robinson, Marcelo Pleitez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, & Abel Valenzuela, Jr.

*Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds in California's Congressional Districts* (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Paul M. Ong, Silvia R. Gonzalez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Jonathan Ong, & Chhandara Pech.

*Vote Choice of Latino Voters in the 2020 Presidential Election* (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Nick Gonzalez, Angela Gutierrez, Michael Herndon, Ana Oaxaca, Michael Rios, Marcel Roman, Tye Rush, & Daisy Vera.

*Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds Between Majority-White Neighborhoods and Neighborhoods of Color in California* (2020). UCLA LPPI. –with Silvia R. Gonzalez, Paul M. Ong, Chhandara Pech, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas.

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| MEDIA COVERAGE<br>& INTERVIEWS               | <b>English:</b> Associated Press (AP) News; Forbes; The Hill; KPCC–NPR News; Washington Post; USA Today; ABC News; Milwaukee PBS; Voice of America<br><b>Spanish:</b> Telemundo; Univision–Los Angeles; Milwaukee PBS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |
| PROFESSIONAL<br>ACTIVITIES &<br>AFFILIATIONS | US Census Bureau: Special Sworn Status<br>American Society for Hispanic Economists (ASHE)<br>American Economic Association, Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP)<br>Association for Economic Research of Indigenous Peoples (AERIP)<br>AEA Summer Program Alumni (Advanced Track)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                     |
| PROFESSIONAL<br>DEVELOPMENT                  | Economics of Migration Summer Institute, UC Davis<br>Stone Center Summer Institute on Inequality, UC Berkeley<br>Path to the Professoriate Program, Office of Graduate Diversity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2023<br>2023<br>2021-2022                                                                                                                           |
| SERVICE                                      | BEE Graduate Student Admission Review Committee<br>Graduate Mentor, Getting Into Graduate School (GiGS)<br>Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE<br>Graduate Mentor, Social Sciences Research Pathways<br>Co-President, Economists for Equity at Berkeley (BEE)<br>Invited Speaker: MPP & Beyond, PPIA Junior Summer Institute<br>Committee Member/Doctoral Mentor, BEE Mentoring Program<br>Student Liason, Emerging Scholars Reading Group<br>Co-Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE<br>Organizing Member, UCLA Luskin Admission Review Committee<br>Lead Convener, Kern Food Policy Council Working Groups<br>AmeriCorps VISTA (placed at CSU Bakersfield) | 2023-2026<br>2023-2026<br>2024-2025<br>2024-2027<br>2023-2024<br>2023<br>2022-2023<br>2022-2023<br>2022-2023<br>2018-2019<br>2017-2018<br>2017-2018 |
| LANGUAGES                                    | English (fluent); Spanish (native)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                     |
| SKILLS                                       | <b>Programming:</b> Stata, R, SAS, $\text{\LaTeX}$<br><b>Policy:</b> Reports, memos, briefs & blogs; media coverage (print, radio, television)<br><b>Teaching:</b> Content creation, instruction, management, grading, & 1-on-1 research guidance of graduate and undergraduate students                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                     |

*CV Updated: September 15, 2026*